

Why you're not being found.

What's actually happening on the backend of LinkedIn search and what to do about it.

The applicant funnel has quietly broken.

This is what you are actually up against.

1,200+

Applicants on a single remote role, within days of posting

LinkedIn Talent Solutions, 2025

8.4%

Of applicants ever reach a scheduled interview — down from ~12% a decade ago

Employing Benchmarks, 2026

<1%

Realistic odds of receiving an offer through a cold application alone

SHRM Talent Benchmarks, 2025

70%

Of qualified professionals today are passive — they don't apply. They **get found**.

LinkedIn Talent Solutions, 2025



Volume is up. Trust is down.

Hiring has split into two paths.

PATH 01 — WHAT YOU THINK IS HAPPENING

The Application Path

- 1 You see the job posting
- 2 You apply through the portal
- 3 Recruiter reviews your resume
- 4 You get the interview
- 5 You get the offer

~30% of professionals are active job seekers at any given time.

Still exists — but no longer how most hires happen. Source: LinkedIn Talent Solutions

PATH 02 — WHAT'S ACTUALLY HAPPENING

The Sourcing Path

- 1 Recruiter searches LinkedIn
- 2 Shortlists 5–10 profiles
- 3 Reaches out via InMail
- 4 Interview is scheduled
- 5 Offer extended

~70% of professionals are passive talent. They don't apply. They get found.

Source: LinkedIn Talent Solutions

*The best candidates often don't apply. They get **found**.*

Their LinkedIn profile does the work. Recruiters reach them through search because they are visible, specific, and unmistakably searchable. That is now the most important job a profile does.

You're being scraped, scored, and ranked by AI.

These platforms continuously crawl LinkedIn, GitHub, and public profiles — building candidate files before any job is posted. If your keywords don't match their filters, you never surface.

LinkedIn Recruiter INDUSTRY STANDARD The primary sourcing tool. Boolean search + filters.	SeekOut AI SEARCH Indexes LinkedIn, GitHub, patents. Tech + healthcare.	hireEZ AI SOURCING Scrapes 800M+ profiles across the open web.	Gem SOURCING + CRM Tracks candidates, auto-personalizes outreach.
Pin.com AI END-TO-END Searches 650M+ profiles. Auto-ranks, writes outreach, books interviews.	Findem INTELLIGENCE Combines LinkedIn + behavioral + trajectory data.	EightFold AI ENTERPRISE Used by large enterprises. Ranks talent vs specs.	Amazing Hiring TECHNICAL Deep indexing of GitHub, Stack Overflow, Kaggle.

EXAMPLE OF SOURCING TOOL FROM RECRUITER'S VIEW

 Recruiting Manager ✓

~137.4K candidates

✦ Auto-Outreach

Table View ▼

Export ▼

✦ Recruiter, United States, 5+ years, Agency Recruiting and Clinical Recruiting, Healthcare, English +12 criteria

NAME	JOB TITLE	EXPERIENCE	QUALIFIERS
SK Shane Krumm	Recruiter	15yr 3mo	✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓ +1
NG Nathan Gilroy	Human Resources Generalist / Recruiter	28yr 3mo	✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓ 0
SL Sherri Lloyd	Independent Travel Agent	19yr 2mo	✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓✓ 0
BR Brittany Rowles	Lead Corporate and Executive Recruiter	16yr 4mo	✓✓ ✗ ✓✓✓✓✓✓✗ ✓✓✓ +1
KJ Kyle J.	Talent Acquisition Recruiter	11yr 4mo	✓✓ ✗ ✓✓✓✓✓✓✗ ✓✓✓ +1

Sometimes the recruiter doesn't search at all.

When a recruiter posts a job, LinkedIn hands them a stack of matching candidates before any search happens. Your profile is either in that stack, or it isn't.

The three signals it runs on.

01

What the job needs

The required skills, title, and location feed straight into the algorithm. If your profile uses different words, you don't get matched.

02

Whether you're open

Turn on Open to Work in private mode (recruiters only, hidden from your boss). It moves you to the top of the stack instantly.

03

Who the recruiter likes

Every candidate they save or message teaches the algorithm their taste. You want to be one of the ones they save.

35%

Higher InMail acceptance from candidates the algorithm surfaces vs. candidates found by boolean search alone. *LinkedIn Talent Solutions, 2025*

The job goes up and you're already in the stack

JOB POSTING

Senior Marketing Manager

Acme SaaS • Seattle, WA • Hybrid

REQUIRED SKILLS

Paid Social

Demand Gen

B2B SaaS

HubSpot

Salesforce

ABM

Marketing Ops

Seniority

Industry

Function

Experience

Senior

SaaS

Marketing

5–8 years

Posted 11 minutes ago

Recommended Matches AI Showing 4 of 47 candidates

SC

Sarah C. OPEN TO WORK
Senior Marketing Manager • B2B SaaS • Paid Social
Seattle, WA • 7 yrs experience

8/8
SKILLS

MR

Marcus R. OPEN TO WORK
Marketing Director • B2B SaaS • Demand Gen
Bellevue, WA • 9 yrs experience • 2nd connection

7/8
SKILLS

PK

Priya K.
Head of Marketing • B2B Tech • Paid Media
Seattle, WA • 8 yrs experience

7/8
SKILLS

JT

James T.
Sr. Demand Gen Manager • SaaS • Marketo
Tacoma, WA • 6 yrs experience • Recently promoted

6/8
SKILLS

→ The recruiter hasn't typed a single character. They're already deciding who to message. **You're either on this list, or you're not.**

THE RECRUITER WORKFLOW

Recruiters don't browse. They filter.

A recruiter working a single role opens LinkedIn Recruiter, types a search, and moves fast. Here's what that actually looks like — start to finish.

STEP 01

Build a boolean search string

Title + industry + skills + synonyms

STEP 02

Apply structured filters

Location, experience, company size, tenure

STEP 3

Scan the result set in seconds

Roughly 3 seconds per profile

STEP 4

Open 5–10 that pass the scan

Headline + current title + recent experience

STEP 5

Message 3–5

Total time: under 20 minutes per role

This is what a real boolean search looks like.

AND – both required

OR – either quality

NOT – excludes the term

" – exact phrase

(– groups logic

Customer Success Manager • SaaS

"Customer Success Manager" OR "CSM" AND "SaaS" AND (onboarding OR "customer onboarding") AND (retention OR churn) NOT intern

Project Manager • Healthcare IT

"Project Manager" AND ("healthcare" OR "health system") AND (EPIC OR Cerner) AND PMP NOT "project coordinator"

Senior Marketing Leader • B2B

"VP Marketing" OR "Marketing Director" AND B2B AND ("demand gen" OR "demand generation") AND ("Series A" OR "Series B") NOT agency

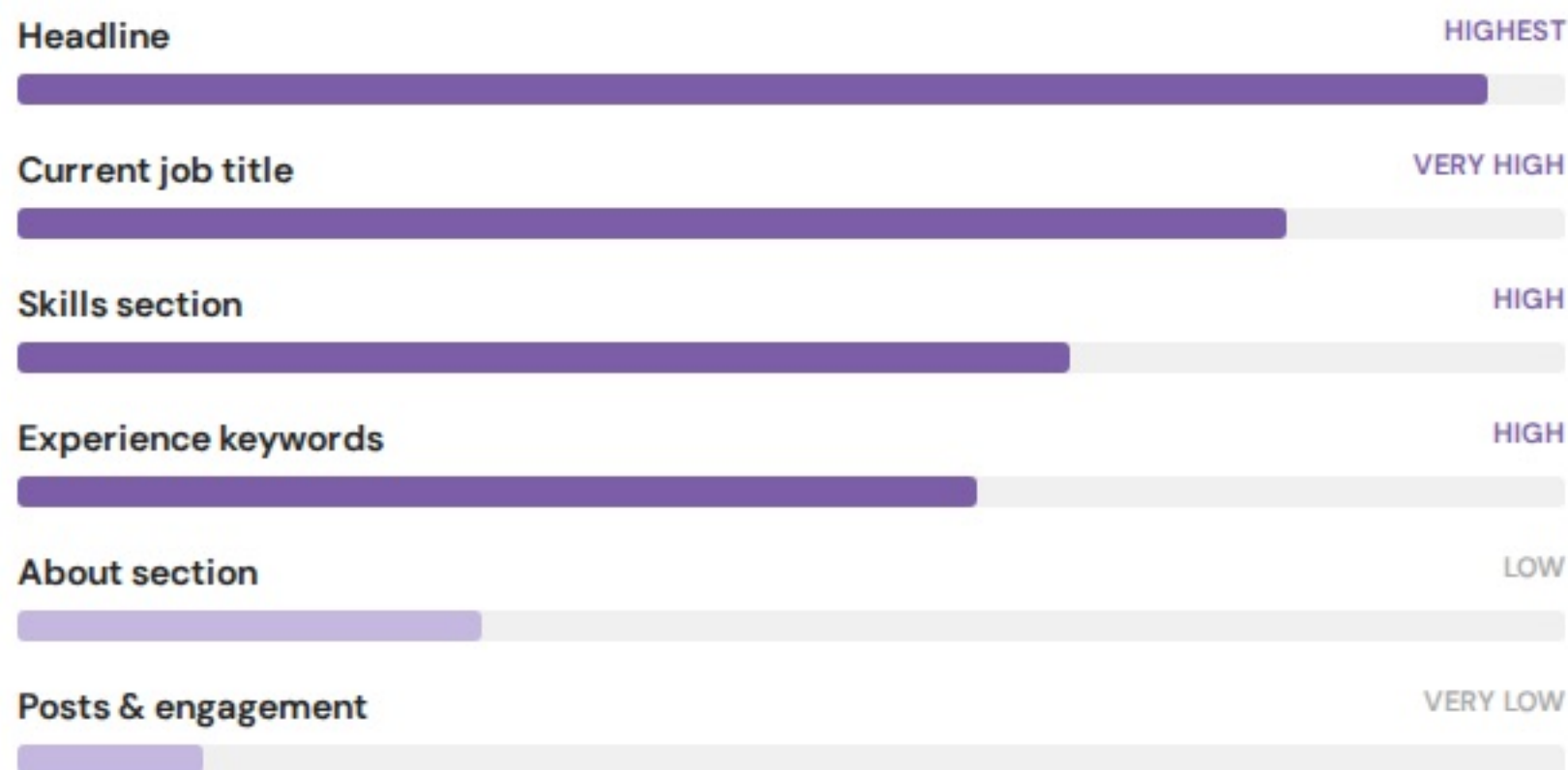
Your mission: figure out the string a recruiter would type for your ideal role — then make sure every term lives on your profile.

LinkedIn Recruiter unlocks 40+ advanced filters a regular account will never see.

SEARCH FILTERS	SPOTLIGHTS — UNIQUE TO RECRUITER
Keywords (Boolean) "Marketing Manager" and "Paid Social"	✓ Open to new opportunities ✓ More likely to respond
Job titles 3	☐ Engaging with your talent brand
Skills & assessments 5	☐ Recently promoted
Years of experience	☐ Has company connections
Current companies	☐ Past applicants to your roles
Past companies	☐ Workplace type (Remote/Hybrid/On-site)
Years in current role	+ 20 more filters unavailable to you
Seniority level	

Not every part of your profile ranks the same

LinkedIn weights certain fields heavily and nearly ignores others. Knowing this changes where you spend your time.



THE SKILLS GAP

You get to add 50 skills. Most people only add a fraction.

48% of Recruiters on LinkedIn now fill roles using skills data alone.

LinkedIn Talent Solutions, 2024

THE REAL BOTTLENECK

It isn't lack of experience.

It isn't lack of effort.

*It's keyword alignment
with how recruiters
actually search.*

The good news: this is the single most fixable problem in your job search. You don't need more credentials. You need a profile built for search.

Your headline is your most valuable real estate.

The formula: [Role Title] | [Industry] | [Skill] | [Credential]

— INVISIBLE TO SEARCH

"Passionate about helping people find their next opportunity"

"Results-driven leader | Open to Work"

"Strategic thinker building the future of work"

— BUILT FOR SEARCH

HR Business Partner | Mid-Market SaaS | DEI

Customer Success Manager | B2B SaaS | Onboarding

Project Manager | Healthcare IT | Epic | PMP



Sarah Chen

Senior Marketing Manager | B2B SaaS | Paid Social | Demand
Gen

Seattle, WA • 500+ connections

*This is where your headline
lives*

Your current title is LinkedIn’s *primary signal*. Don’t leave it blank or cute.

The formula: [Specific Role] | [Industry / Specialty] | (optional) Open to Opportunities

— INVISIBLE IN SEARCH

- "Open to New Opportunities"
- "Seeking my next chapter"
- "In career transition"
- "Leader, defining the future of marketing"

— BUILT FOR SEARCH

- Senior Marketing Manager | Paid Social
- Project Manager | Healthcare IT | Contract
- HR Business Partner | Open to Remote
- Director of Product | B2B SaaS

Experience

A

Senior Marketing Manager | Paid Social

Acme SaaS • Full-time
Mar 2024 — Present • Seattle, WA

P

Marketing Manager

Previous Co. • Jan 2020 — Mar 2024

*Leadership-speak matches **zero** searches. Specifics match **everything**.*

VAGUE — INVISIBLE TO RECRUITERS

- Led cross-functional initiatives to drive business outcomes across the organization.
- Partnered with key stakeholders to deliver impactful, high-visibility results.
- Championed strategic priorities in a dynamic, fast-paced environment.

ZERO KEYWORDS RECRUITERS CAN FIND

SPECIFIC — INDEXED AND SEARCHABLE

- Managed **\$2M annual paid social** budget across **Meta, TikTok, and LinkedIn Ads** for **B2B SaaS** clients (\$50M–\$200M ARR).
- Launched **ABM demand gen** campaigns that reduced **CAC by 34%**.
- Owned marketing ops in **HubSpot, Salesforce, and Marketo**. Built attribution in **Looker**.

11 SEARCHABLE KEYWORDS. EVERY ONE INDEXED.

Every tool, platform, vertical, skill, methodology, and named outcome is a keyword. Walk through every role on your profile — name the stack, the metric, the deliverable.

A searchable profile gets you found. Smart engagement gets you remembered.

40X

More opportunities land in complete profiles vs. incomplete ones — LinkedIn's algorithm promotes profile completeness in search.

LinkedIn Data, 2023

3.2X

More profile views for members with 500+ connections vs. fewer than 100. Network size is a ranking signal.

LinkedIn Data, 2023

5+

Thoughtful comments per day signal you as "active" to the algorithm — driving more visibility than any content you post.

Richard van der Blom, 2023

The job seeker's playbook

- 1 **Comment before you post.** Drop 5 substantive comments on posts by hiring managers, recruiters, and people in your target — every weekday.
- 2 **Post 2–3x per week, not daily.** Share a lesson, a framework, or a case study from your experience. Under 1,500 characters. Line breaks matter.
- 3 **Lead with a hook.** The first line is all most people see. Make it specific — a number, a question, or a contradiction.
- 4 **Reply to every comment in the first hour.** Early comment velocity is the single biggest reach lever the algorithm watches.
- 5 **Grow to 500+ connections deliberately.** Connect with people in your target role, industry, and target companies — not just everyone.

Three things to do now:

01

Run the recruiter search on yourself.

Open LinkedIn. Search the job title you want. Apply the filters a recruiter would. Would you show up on page one? Page three? At all?

02

Rewrite your headline. Today.

Use the formula. Make it searchable, not poetic. Recruiters reward precision, not creativity. Every word is inventory.

03

Reverse-engineer 3 job descriptions.

Pull 3 listings for your target role. Copy every recurring keyword. Audit your profile against that list. The gaps are your playbook.

REMEMBER THIS

***You're not being ignored.
You're just not being found.***

Thank you.

Stephanie Murray